

Buckinghamshire, Oxfordshire and Berkshire region and Frimley ICS

Integrated Clinical Academic (ICA) Programme

HEE/NIHR ICA Internship

Information and application process

For further information contact

Dr Zoe Davey, Internship Programme Manager

zdavey@brookes.ac.uk

Introduction

Health Education England (HEE) and the National Institute for Health Research (NIHR) have established an overarching Integrated Clinical Academic (ICA) Programme for nursing, midwifery, and allied health professionals (NMAHPs). This programme is intended to increase research capacity to improve health and healthcare, by developing people with the potential and aspiration to become leading clinical academics and independent researchers in the future.

We have received national funding to support a number of internships in the Thames Valley. These awards support individuals who are early in their clinical academic career and will be delivered through the Oxford Institute of Nursing, Midwifery and Allied Health Research (OxINMAHR), Faculty of Health and Life Sciences at Oxford Brookes University (brookes.ac.uk/oxinmahr/).

The internships will provide an introduction to a range of concepts and approaches relating to applied health research aimed at supporting Nursing, Midwifery and Allied Health Professional interns to apply for an NIHR Pre-doctoral Clinical Academic Fellowship (PCAF); an NIHR Clinical Doctoral Research Fellowship (CDRF), and/or work within a research team that will submit a proposal for funding

It is important for successful interns to have support from their line manager. The objectives of the internship and future clinical academic aspirations should align with team/service clinical priorities and needs. Applications are particularly welcomed where the focus of the proposed research is in the following HEE priority areas: Improving the experience of people with dementia; Primary and community care; Compassionate care and the NHS Constitution; Urgent & Emergency care; Care for people with Intellectual Disabilities; Improving Patient Safety; Technology Enhanced Learning

For further information about the HEE-NIHR ICA Programme please follow the link below:
<https://www.nihr.ac.uk/explore-nihr/academy-programmes/hee-nihr-integrated-clinical-academic-programme.htm>

1. The ICA internship programme basics

This programme will provide an introduction to a range of concepts and approaches relating to applied health research aimed at supporting Nursing, Midwifery and Allied Health Professionals (NMAHP) interns to:

- apply for an NIHR Pre-doctoral Clinical Academic Fellowship (PCAF)
- apply for an NIHR Clinical Doctoral Research Fellowship (CDRF)
- work within a research team that will submit a proposal for funding

The programme is designed to be fully aligned with the intern's current clinical practice and will include an NMAHP cohort of six interns over a three-year period (2021/22 – 2023/24) from across the region.

The Buckinghamshire, Oxfordshire and Berkshire region and Frimley ICS ICA internships will be delivered through the Oxford Institute of Nursing, Midwifery and Allied Health Research (OxINMAHR), Faculty of Health and Life Sciences at Oxford Brookes University.

The funding also covers 100 hours of salary backfill per intern to release the interns from their employing NHS Trust. The intern is required to negotiate the 100 hours of "release time" with their clinical line manager (OBU to assist as appropriate).

2. Oxford Brookes programme delivery

2.1 The programme will include:

- Personal support from an academic supervisor
- Enrolment in an existing taught research methods module
- Directed reading and support.
- Integration into a dedicated research active environment
- Access to computer, relevant virtual learning platforms and library facilities
- Opportunity to become part of a vibrant research community

2.2 Induction Programme

- The OxINMAHR internship programme manager will be responsible for the induction programme and be the main point of contact throughout the internship.
- Outline of the Educational Learning Package (the programme, taught module, expectations, academic and NHS mentorship).
- Seminars on how to use library resources, an introduction to the Virtual Learning Platform (VLP) 'Moodle', access to other online resources including Turnitin

2.3 Mentorship and supervision

- The aim of the mentorship is to support and guide the intern to formulate a research project for PCAF or CDRF fellowship (or grant award) application
- OxINMAHR will allocate an academic mentor that is most suited to the needs of the intern.
- The academic mentor will meet monthly (virtual) with the intern to discuss research activity and tailored requirements
- The academic mentor will receive and comment on research project development and PCAF/CDRF Fellowship application (or grant funding application) in a timely and